Jnatata (the property of having been known): in opposition to Buddhists such as ***Dharmakirti***, who maintained that we cannot distinguish objects from our awareness of objects (***sahopalambha-niyama***), the ***Purva Mimamsaka*** realist philosopher ***Kumarila*** *Bhatta* insists that no experiences are just generated by consciousness. Consciousness has no perspective upon itself and is not self-aware, as one thing cannot possess two operations simultaneously. It only has the power to manifest or reveal objects and is not reflexive or self-revealing (*sva-prakasha*) because a cognition, while illuminating an object cannot also illumine itself. He argues that just as we have no direct perception of the sensory faculties but infer their existence from the fact that we have experiences of colours and so on, so the existence of consciousness is inferred from the fact that external objects are known. There is no experience of cognition unless some object is known. He holds that knowledge is a type of action (*kriya*), not formed entity. As a realist, he insists on a difference between objects (***artha*** – things) and objects-as-known (*vishaya* – mental content). Only actions can make a difference and bring about a difference in what is acted upon. The act of knowing changes the object into something known. We are not aware of the act of knowing at the time when it occurs. That it has happened is inferred from the fact that the property knowness (*jnatata*) is found to have been produced in some object. We know that we know something by a type of inference (***arthapatti***) from this effect in the object, not by looking within.

The soul, the bearer of the good and bad consequences of one's – especially ritual – actions does not reveal itself as the subject in acts of knowing. Rather, it is the object of the thought 'I', which does not in itself luminously manifest one's basic identity. Its existence is inferred as that which must be the continuing subject of experience.